centre for pediatric emergencies and specialized care

Waterproof Cast Care

What can you do with a waterproof cast?

- **You can wash hands**, shower and bathe using a mild soap, then rinse the cast with water.
- **You can swim in a swimming pool** with your cast. Afterwards, thoroughly rinse your cast with clean water.

How should you dry the cast after getting it wet?

After getting wet, it is important to dry the skin underneath the cast to avoid skin irritation

- **Let the water drain** from the lower end of the cast for a few minutes. Make sure to let the foot or arm hang at an angle to avoid water accumulating in the joints (ex. heel)
- **Do not cover the cast** while it is drying
- **Use a hair dryer** on cool setting to push water out of the cast and shorten the drying time. Do not use hot air as this may burn

How can you keep the cast in good shape?

- **Keep it clean.** Avoid getting dirt or sand inside the cast
- **Avoid lotions.** Do not place powder, lotion, cream or deodorant on or underneath the cast
- **Do not insert objects inside the cast.** Do not scratch the skin underneath the cast with an object as this can damage the skin or the cast
- **Leave cast changes to your doctor.** Do not trim the cast edges or pull padding out of the cast
- **Rinse the inside of the cast daily**. This will remove sweat, dead skin, help reduce odors and itching

What should you expect in the first week?

You may have **PAIN** for the first week. To control your pain:

- Use Ibuprofen or Acetaminophen (unless allergic). Follow the instructions on the bottle
- Keep the broken bone raised, using a sling/pillow, to lower the swelling

The skin underneath your cast may feel **ITCHY**. This is normal. To relieve itchy skin:

- Rinse out the cast with water or use a hair dryer (on cool setting) to blow air into the cast. You can even touch the hair dryer directly to the cast using the vibrations to help with the itch

Do we need a follow-up appointment?

Yes, our team will book an appointment for you for a re-assessment and/or cast removal at UP. If a referral to an orthopedic or plastic surgeon was needed, our team will ensure to transmit the referral electronically and inform you of next steps.

What complications should I monitor for?

- There is redness on the skin around the cast edges
- Your pain is getting worse, or pain medications are not helping
- Your fingers or toes become blue or white
- An object has fallen into the cast or the cast is broken

What do I do if have a complication?

Return to Centre UP at the site closest to your home between 8am-8pm; no appointment needed. If notice something at night, unless severe pain or major concern, can come first thing in the AM.